

What is happening in Heroic Ignivar's Forge

Every recorded heroic pull on Claudemoon, and the one mechanic that is ending the night

Realm Claudemoon | build 0.41.1 | 1 September 2026 | source: Parses, environment prod

The raid is not short on damage, and it is not dying to anything it cannot heal. It is losing to a single unpressured cast. Varkhul, Forgefather of the Last Flame, seals himself at 50 percent health and summons an Assembly. Three Cinder Artificers inside that Assembly channel a six second cast that heals him for 3 percent each time it lands. On every pull inspected the raid interrupted that cast zero times and killed zero Artificers. Varkhul has never been pushed below 50.0 percent, and in the last ten attempts he was back at full health before the raid died.

23	0	50.0%	0
HEROIC PULLS ON VARKHUL	KILLS	BEST HEALTH REACHED, EVERY PULL	INTERRUPTS ON ANY PULL INSPECTED

The night, encounter by encounter

Time (UTC)	Encounter	Type	Result	Reading
12:15	Forge Approach	Trash	1 clear	Walked through. No obstacle.
12:53 to 13:50	Ignivar, Herald of the Last Flame	Boss	1 kill, 19 wipes	A damage race. Solved, narrowly, on the twentieth try.
13:56	Molten Assembly	Trash	2 clears	Walked through. No obstacle.
14:03 to 16:24	Varkhul, Forgefather of the Last Flame	Boss	0 kills, 23 wipes	The wall. Two hours and twenty minutes, no progress past 50 percent.

Sources: the Parses service, environment prod, realm Claudemoon, game build 0.41.1. Every figure in this report comes from recorded fight data. Timings are converted from game ticks at 20 ticks per second.

The wall: Varkhul and the Master's Assembly

Varkhul has 200,000 health on heroic. The raid burns him down at a steady, healthy pace and reaches 50 percent in roughly 90 seconds. That part is fine. Everything that decides the pull happens afterwards.

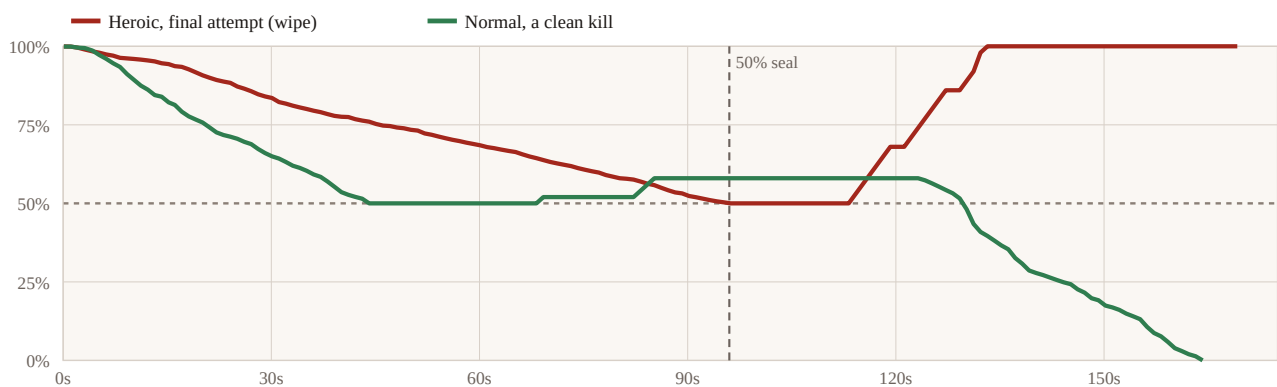
At exactly 100,000 health, three things happen at once:

- Varkhul stops taking damage. In all 23 attempts his health never moved below 100,000, not by a single point.
- He gains a buff the log names **The Master's Assembly**, applied once and never removed for the rest of the pull.
- Waves of adds spawn: Ember Sentinels, Crucible Wardens, and, critically, **Cinder Artificers**.

The mechanic the raid is missing

Cinder Artificers channel **Cinder Recalibrate**, a six second cast. Every time it completes, Varkhul heals for 6,000 health, which is 3 percent of his maximum. Three Artificers channel it on a loop with about a two second gap between casts. Left alone, they restore the entire 50 percent in around forty seconds. A six second cast is one of the longest and most interruptible casts in the encounter, and the raid never once contested it.

Varkhul's health through a pull: the heroic wipe against a normal-mode kill



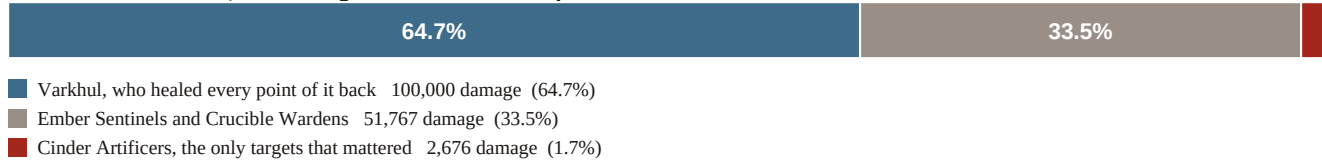
The two curves are the whole story. Both raids reach the seal at 50 percent and both enter the Assembly. The normal-mode group kills all three Artificers within 60 seconds, so only four Recalibrate casts land and the boss creeps up to 58 percent before the phase releases and he dies. The heroic group kills none, seventeen casts land, and Varkhul is restored to 200,000 health with the raid still standing in the room.

	Normal (kill)	Heroic (wipe)
Boss maximum health	120,000	200,000
Heal per Cinder Recalibrate	2,400 (2%)	6,000 (3%)
Casts that landed	4	17
Health handed back	+9,600 (8%)	+100,000 (50%)
Cinder Artificers killed	3 of 3	0 of 3
Outcome	Boss dead at 164s	Raid dead at 169s

The evidence, from the final pull

Attempt 23 is the cleanest example because the raid survived longest in the Assembly. It ran 169 seconds and ended with all ten players dead and the boss at full health.

Where the raid's 154,443 damage went on the final pull



All three Artificers survived. They out-healed the raid on 1.7 percent of its attention.

Roughly 100,000 of that damage went into a boss who gave every point of it back. Another 51,767 went into Ember Sentinels and Crucible Wardens, the adds that do not matter, and eleven of them died. The three Cinder Artificers, the only targets whose deaths would have ended the healing, absorbed **2,676 damage between them and all three survived**. For scale, an Ember Sentinel in this pull died after about 3,400 damage and a Crucible Warden after about 4,100. The busiest Artificer took 1,453, so it was somewhere near halfway dead. The other two were barely scratched. These were not tough targets. They were untouched ones.

The cast log

From the moment the Assembly formed to the moment the last player died, the Artificers cast Cinder Recalibrate continuously. Fourteen casts completed. One shows as interrupted, and that interruption is the fight ending, not a player acting. No participant in the pull recorded a single interrupt or a single dispel.

The raid was not short of interrupts

The ten players on that pull were two rogues, five warriors, one fire mage and two holy priests. Three of the warriors were talented into Storm Bolt. Between the rogues, the warriors and the mage there were roughly eight interrupt effects available against a six second cast repeating on a loop for over a minute. The recorded count for the pull is zero.

How the raid actually died

The wipe itself is quick and it comes at the end. For 146 of the 169 seconds nobody was in danger. Then, in 27 seconds:

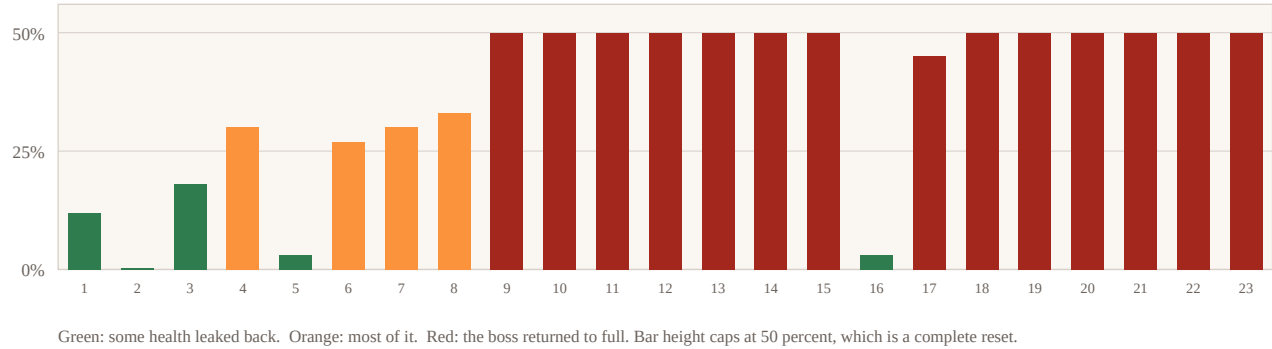
Time	Who	Killed by	Note
141.1s	Kokolina, holy priest	Crucible Beam	The first player death of the pull is a healer.
153.1s	SirChargeALot, fury warrior	Crucible Beam	
163.1s	Grohnk, fury warrior	Crucible Beam	
166.1s	Gnotib, fury warrior	Forge Meltdown	1,577 damage in one hit.
168.1s	Priestdim, Veso and Hellscream	Forge Meltdown	Three players in the same instant.
168.2s	HanzoKal and Sir Backstab, rogues	Add melee	Finished off by the adds nobody could hold any more.

This ordering matters. Losing the healer first, then four players to one Forge Meltdown, reads like a healing failure, and a raid reviewing the death log alone would reasonably go looking for more healing. It is not a healing failure. By that point the raid had spent more than a minute fighting a boss at full health with an add pack that keeps growing, and no amount of throughput changes that arithmetic. The two priests were already overhealing 58 percent of everything they cast.

Twenty-three attempts, and the trend is backwards

The natural read on a progression night is that wipes get better. Here they get worse, and the reason is instructive. Because nobody is stopping the healing, surviving longer in the Assembly simply means the boss recovers more. Improving at staying alive actively made the results look worse.

Health handed back to Varkhul, attempt by attempt (23 heroic pulls, chronological)



Attempts 2 and 16 leaked almost nothing, but not because they were played well. Those pulls ended early, so the Assembly barely had time to channel. From attempt 9 onward the pattern is fixed: the raid reaches the seal at around 90 seconds, holds for another 50 to 70 seconds, and hands back the full 50 percent in the process.

Measure	Across all 23 heroic attempts
Lowest health Varkhul ever reached	Exactly 50.0 percent, in every single attempt. The value is 100,000 of 200,000 to the point.
Time to reach the seal	Between 72.8 and 100.5 seconds. Consistent and comfortable.
Attempt length	110.5 to 169.2 seconds. Trending longer as the night went on.
Attempts ending with the boss at full health	14 of 23, including 8 of the last 9.
Interrupts and dispels	Zero on attempts 1, 12 and 23, across all 30 participant rows.

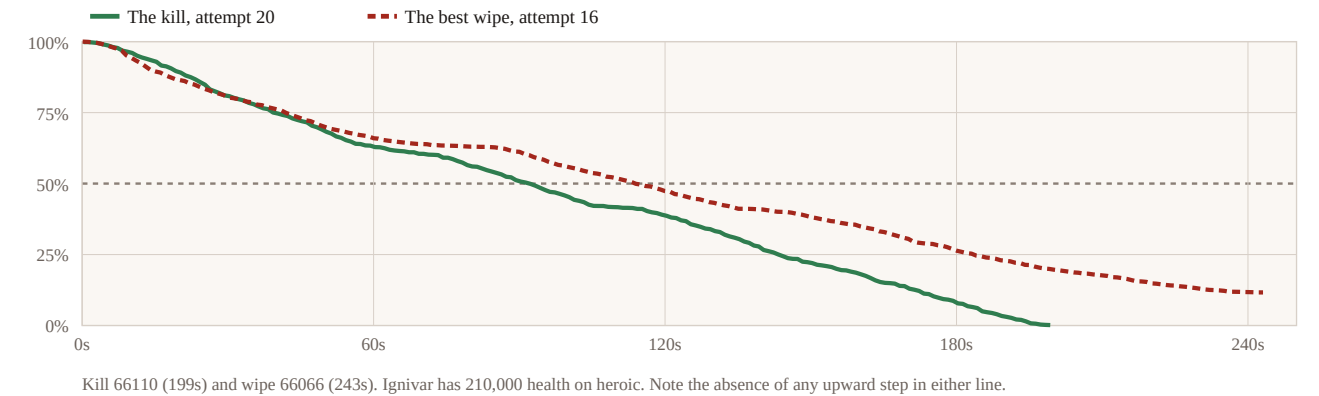
What this means in practice

The raid has never seen the second half of this encounter. Everything past 50 percent, including whatever Varkhul does when the Assembly is actually broken, is unexplored. This is not a tuning problem or a gear problem, and more damage on the boss will not help: it all gets refunded. It is one target-priority call and one interrupt rotation.

Ignivar, for contrast: a fight the raid solved

Before hitting the Varkhul wall the raid spent an hour on Ignivar, Herald of the Last Flame, and killed him on the twentieth attempt. Worth reading, because it shows the group is capable and confirms that Varkhul is a knowledge problem rather than a capability one.

Ignivar: a clean damage race with no reset and no seal



Ignivar's health only ever goes down. There is no seal, no add phase and no healing to contest, so the encounter is an endurance check against a rising damage profile. Both lines descend steadily. The kill simply descended faster and finished in 199 seconds with the boss on 311 health, which is 0.15 percent. It was close.

The wipe took the boss to 11.7 percent over 243 seconds and then met two abilities that never appear in the kill at all: **Chains of the Forge** and **Last Inferno**. These land for between 129,960 and 275,951 damage against players who have roughly 3,400 maximum health. They are not survivable and they are not meant to be. Ignivar's ordinary kit, the Searing Torrent and Forge Strike on the tanks, the Brand of the Pyre stacking burn, Falling Cinders, Revolving Inferno and Cleansing Backlash on the raid, is all healable. The fight is a clock, and the raid beat it with about 44 seconds to spare.

What was different on the kill

	The 19 wipes (sample)	The kill
Time to kill	Best reached 11.7% at 243s	Boss dead at 199s
Top damage dealer	Fire mage or fury warrior	Balance druid, 39,049 damage
Composition	Melee-heavy	Balance druid and holy paladin present
Ending	Chains of the Forge, then Last Inferno	Neither ability ever fired

The comparison points somewhere useful, and it also flags a drift worth noticing. The Ignivar kill group brought a balance druid and a holy paladin, and both were still there for the first Varkhul attempt. By attempt 12 they were gone, replaced by more warriors and a second holy priest, and the roster stayed that way through attempt 23: five warriors, two rogues, one mage and two priests, with no druid, paladin, shaman, hunter or warlock. The raid shed its ranged damage over the course of the night, which is the wrong direction for an add phase spread across a room. It is a contributing factor. It is not the cause. The cause is that nobody attacked the Cinder Artificers.

What to change, in order

Nothing below asks the raid to play better in the abstract. Every item is a target-priority or interrupt decision that can be made before the next pull.

- **Assign the Artificers before the pull.** When Varkhul seals at 50 percent, every damage dealer swaps to Cinder Artificers and nothing else. On normal, killing all three ends the problem and the phase releases shortly after.
- **Set an interrupt rotation on Cinder Recalibrate.** Six seconds is a long cast. Two rogues and three Storm Bolt warriors can cover it indefinitely. Every interrupt is 6,000 health the raid does not have to deal twice.
- **Stop tunnelling the boss during the seal.** Roughly 100,000 damage went into a target that could not be hurt and was healing anyway. That is the single largest pool of wasted effort on the night.
- **Leave the Sentinels and Wardens to the tanks.** Eleven died to raid damage that should have gone elsewhere. They are a threat problem, not a damage one.
- **Do not add healing.** The two priests already overhealed 75,501 against 55,414 effective. The deaths at the end follow from the phase never ending.
- **Bring the ranged damage back.** The balance druid and holy paladin who were there for the Ignivar kill and the first Varkhul attempt were gone by attempt 12 and never returned. Ranged damage is worth more, not less, against a spread add phase.

The one-line summary

Heroic Ignivar's Forge is not beating this raid on damage, healing or survival. Varkhul seals at 50 percent and three Cinder Artificers heal him back to full with a six second cast that has never been interrupted and on targets that have never been killed. Kill the Artificers and the raid will see content it has not seen yet.

Method note. Every number is drawn from recorded fight data on the Parses service for realm Claudemoon, environment prod, game build 0.41.1, all on 1 September 2026. Boss health curves come from sampled resource tracks. Boss health floors were checked on all 23 heroic Varkhul attempts. Ability breakdowns, cast timelines, aura uptimes and death recaps were read in full for heroic attempt 66500, heroic Ignivar kill 66110 and wipe 66066, and normal-mode Varkhul kill 67212. Interrupt counts, dispel counts and rosters are the per-participant totals the service records, inspected on heroic Varkhul pulls 66146, 66313 and 66500, which are attempts 1, 12 and 23, and on Ignivar kill 66110. All 40 participant rows across those four pulls show zero interrupts and zero dispels. The remaining 20 Varkhul pulls were checked for boss health only. This raid does not exist in the checked-out source tree, which is at build 0.35.1, so mechanics here are inferred from combat logs rather than read from encounter scripts.